

Athena's Little Owl

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.



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Read aloud, or let an older child read it themselves. Pause at each question so the heroes can decide together. There are no wrong answers here, only kinder ideas to try.

Before you begin

The fog came down over the hills before dawn, soft and grey and thick as wool, and with it came a small, lost sound: the frightened hoot of an owl. When the Olive Town woke, there in the middle of the square sat a tiny owl, her feathers ruffled and her round eyes wide. Her name was Glaux, and she was the companion of wise Athena, whose temple stood high on the hill of white marble. In the fog she had lost her way, and she could not find the road home.

Old Daphne, keeper of the olive grove, called the two of you to her side. "You have sharp eyes and kind hearts," she said, "and that is worth more this morning than the fastest pair of legs in Greece. Will you guide little Glaux safely back up to Athena?"

Gently she wrapped the owl in a soft scarf and placed her in your care. "Remember," she said, "up here we do not help by being the biggest or the boldest. We help by being clever, brave, and kind."

What is your hero name? Which quality will you carry: Wits, Courage, or Heart?

Stop 1: The Foggy Square



Glaux huddled in the heart of the square, so small that the cobblestones seemed huge around her. Her feathers stood on end, her round eyes blinked and blinked, and each time a foot scuffed too near she startled and hopped away. She was far too frightened to be carried anywhere yet.

How could you help her feel safe before you set out? Might you move slowly and keep your voices soft? Might you hold out a steady hand and simply wait for her to choose you? What do

you try?

When you grew calm and gentle and let her come to you in her own time, Glaux stopped her trembling. She studied you with those wise round eyes, gave a small contented hoot, and hopped up onto your waiting hand. From that moment she trusted you completely.

Stop 2: The Whispering Paths



Where the town ended, three narrow paths wound up into the mist, and in the grey half-light each looked exactly like the others. Only one of them climbed to Athena's temple; the other two would lead you in circles until the day was gone.

A goat-legged satyr swung himself up onto a wall, grinning through the fog. It was Bramble, who loved a traveller and a good joke in equal measure, and who was always glad to point the way for heroes he liked.

How will you choose the right path? Look closely at the ground. As Glaux tumbled down in the night she shed soft grey feathers along the way. Could you follow that trail back up? Could you ask cheerful Bramble for a hint? What is your plan?

By following the scattered feathers, or by asking kind Bramble for his help, you found the one true path, and you began to climb together through the drifting mist.

Stop 3: The High Perch



At the summit stood a small temple of white marble, its columns rising into the last of the fog. High among them was Glaux's perch, a snug hollow where she slept each night. But the little owl was weary now, and frightened, and the mist still hid her roost. She did not dare make the flight alone.

This was never about being strong. How might you help her up? Could you lift a steady branch to make a bridge for her small feet? Could you cheer her on, so that she found her courage? What do you do?

When you helped her with patience and kindness, Glaux gathered herself, spread her small wings, and fluttered up to her perch at last. There she settled into the warm hollow, safe and snug, and tucked her head beneath one wing.

Glaux Comes Home



As the owl nestled down, two calm grey eyes opened within the temple, bright as polished silver. It was Athena herself, goddess of wisdom and good ideas, and she was smiling down at the two of you.

At her smile the morning fog began to lift, thinning and curling and floating away, until the sun broke through and poured golden light across the Olive Town far below. From her high perch Glaux gave one clear, happy hoot, as if to say thank you.

You had done it, and you had done it together: with your wits, with your courage, and above all with your kindness. Well done, heroes of the Sunlit Hills.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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